

IIT English Language Course

Comma with "sometimes"

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March 9, 2026

Comma with "sometimes"

In which situations should we add a comma after "sometimes" when it begins a sentence?

With comma

You should add a comma after "sometimes" at the beginning of a sentence in these situations:

1. **When it introduces a longer or more complex introductory phrase or clause that follows it.**
 - Sometimes, when the sun is setting, the sky turns incredible colors.
 - Sometimes, after a long day, all I want is a quiet evening.
2. **When it acts as a "sentence adverb" modifying the entire statement, often creating a slight pause or emphasizing the condition.** This is often a stylistic choice, but common for clarity or flow.
 - Sometimes, it's hard to know what to do.
 - Sometimes, I just need a moment to myself.
3. **For emphasis or rhetorical effect, to create a deliberate pause.**
 - Sometimes, the simplest solutions are the best.

Without comma (normally)

When you can omit the comma (and often do):

- **When "sometimes" directly modifies the verb that immediately follows it, and the sentence is short and clear without the pause.**
 - Sometimes I go for a walk. (Here, "sometimes" directly tells **when** you go.)
 - Sometimes she forgets her keys.